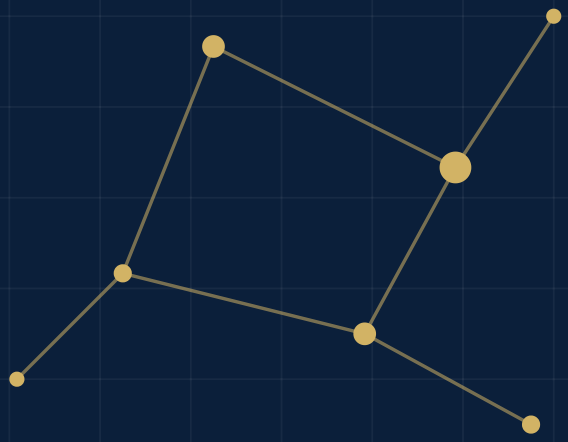


01 — BEFORE DAY 1

Setup Guide

VS Code, Git, Node.js and GitHub Copilot

Get your laptop ready for the workshop: install the tools, switch on GitHub Copilot Free, create the free cloud accounts and run the starter project once.

TIME	COST	WHEN
About 45 minutes	Free tools only	Before Day 1

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Student reference · Guide 1 of 3

November 2026

GUIDE 01 · BEFORE DAY 1

Contents

VS Code, Git, Node.js and GitHub Copilot. Follow the sections in order; each one ends with a checkpoint or checklist.

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PROGRAMME

SRM University workshop

EDITION

November 2026

01 At a glance

Finish this guide on your own laptop **before Day 1**. It takes about 45 minutes with good internet. Everything here is free.

Step	What you set up	Time
1	GitHub account (+ GitHub Education, optional)	5 min
2	Git	5 min
3	Node.js	5 min
4	VS Code	5 min
5	GitHub Copilot Free	5 min
6	VS Code extensions and settings	5 min
7	Test Copilot	5 min
8	Supabase, Google AI Studio and Vercel accounts	5 min
9	Run the starter project	5 min

> **You need:** a laptop running Windows 10/11 or macOS, at least 8 GB RAM and 5 GB of free disk space, an internet connection, and your phone for sign-in codes.

The steps show **Windows** and **Mac** where they differ. Finish with the checklist at the end. Bring your laptop and charger on both days.

02 Step 1: Create a GitHub account

1. Go to github.com/signup.
2. Sign up with your **college email** (this helps with GitHub Education later).
3. Choose a simple, professional username, for example `divya-k-dev`. Recruiters will see it.
4. Verify your email.
5. Turn on two-factor authentication: **Settings** → **Password and authentication** → **Enable two-factor authentication**. Use an authenticator app on your phone.

Optional, but recommended: GitHub Education (Student Developer Pack)

Verified students get extra free tools, including Copilot Pro. Approval can take a few days, so apply at least one week before the workshop.

1. Go to education.github.com/pack and click **Sign up for Student Developer Pack**.
2. Pick your college and upload a photo of your college ID card.

3. Wait for the approval email.

If you are not approved before Day 1, that is fine. **Copilot Free is enough for the workshop.**

03 Step 2: Install Git

Git saves the history of your code and sends it to GitHub.

Windows

1. Download Git from git-scm.com/downloads.
2. Run the installer and keep the default options. Click **Next** until it finishes.

Mac

1. Open **Terminal** and run `git --version`.
2. If Git is not installed, a pop-up asks to install the **Command Line Developer Tools**. Click **Install**.

Both: set your name and email. Open a terminal (Windows: **Git Bash**; Mac: **Terminal**) and run the commands below, using the same email as your GitHub account.

TERMINAL

```
git config --global user.name "Your Name"
git config --global user.email "you@college-email.com"
git config --global init.defaultBranch main
```

> **Check:** `git --version` shows a version number, for example `git version 2.47.0`.

04 Step 3: Install Node.js

Node.js runs our Next.js app. npm (the package installer) comes with it.

1. Go to nodejs.org.
2. Download the **LTS** version (version 22 or later). Do not pick the "Current" version.
3. Run the installer and keep the default options.
   - **Windows:** if it asks about "Tools for Native Modules", leave it unticked.
4. Close and reopen your terminal.

> **Check:** both commands show a version number. `node -v` should show `v22` or higher.

TERMINAL

```
node -v
npm -v
```

05 Step 4: Install VS Code

1. Download VS Code from code.visualstudio.com.
2. Install it:
   - **Windows:** on the "Select Additional Tasks" screen, tick **Add "Open with Code" action** (both boxes) and **Add to PATH**.
   - **Mac:** open the downloaded file and drag **Visual Studio Code** into the **Applications** folder.
3. Open VS Code.
4. **Mac only:** press `Cmd+Shift+P`, type `shell command`, and choose **Shell Command: Install 'code' command in PATH**.
5. **Windows only, set the terminal:** press `Ctrl+Shift+P`, type `default profile`, choose **Terminal: Select Default Profile**, then pick **Git Bash**.
6. Open the built-in terminal with `Ctrl+\`` (Windows) or `Cmd+\`` (Mac).

> **Check:** in the VS Code terminal, `code --version` shows a version number.

06 Step 5: Add GitHub Copilot Free

Copilot Free gives you 2,000 code completions a month, Copilot Chat (with a monthly chat limit), a choice of models and Copilot CLI. No card is needed.

Turn on Copilot Free on GitHub

1. Log in to GitHub and open github.com/settings/copilot.
2. Click **Start using Copilot Free** (or **Get started** on the Free plan).
3. If you already have Copilot Pro from GitHub Education, skip this. You already have access.

Connect Copilot in VS Code

1. In VS Code, open the **Extensions** view (`Ctrl+Shift+X` / `Cmd+Shift+X`).
2. Search for **GitHub Copilot Chat** (publisher: GitHub) and click **Install**. If it says it is already installed, go to the next step.
3. Click the **Copilot icon** in the bottom status bar (or at the top of the window) and choose **Sign in** or **Use Copilot for free**.
4. A browser opens. Click **Authorize Visual Studio Code**, then go back to VS Code.
5. Click the **Accounts** icon at the bottom left. Your GitHub username should appear there.

> **Check:** the Copilot icon in the status bar has no warning sign, and hovering over it shows your plan (Free or Pro).

07 Step 6: Extensions and settings

Install these extensions from the Extensions view (`Ctrl+Shift+X` / `Cmd+Shift+X`). Check the publisher name before you click **Install**.

Extension	Publisher	Why you need it
GitHub Copilot Chat	GitHub	AI coding help (installed in Step 5)
Tailwind CSS IntelliSense	Tailwind Labs	Suggests Tailwind class names
Prettier - Code formatter	Prettier	Keeps code neat
REST Client	Huachao Mao	Test your APIs from a `.http` file
Error Lens	Alexander	Shows errors on the same line

Settings: press `Ctrl+Shift+P` / `Cmd+Shift+P` , type `user settings json` , and choose **Preferences: Open User Settings (JSON)**. Paste these lines inside the `{ }` . If the file already has lines, add a comma after the last one first.

SETTINGS.JSON

```
"files.autoSave": "afterDelay",
"editor.formatOnSave": true,
"editor.defaultFormatter": "esbenp.prettier-vscode",
"editor.inlineSuggest.enabled": true,
"editor.tabSize": 2,
"terminal.integrated.fontSize": 14
```

Save the file with `Ctrl+S` / `Cmd+S` .

08 Step 7: Test Copilot

Do these 4 small tests. They take 5 minutes and use very little of your free quota.

Test 1: Inline suggestions

1. Make a folder called `copilot-test` and open it in VS Code (**File → Open Folder**).
2. Create a file called `test.js` .
3. Type this comment and press `Enter` : `// function that returns true if a number is prime`
4. Grey "ghost" code appears. Press `Tab` to accept it, or `Esc` to reject it.

Test 2: Copilot Chat

1. Open Chat with `Ctrl+Alt+I` (Windows) or `Cmd+Ctrl+I` (Mac), or click the Copilot icon at the top.
2. Type: `Explain the code in #file:test.js in 3 simple lines`
3. You should get an answer.

Test 3: Inline chat

1. Select the function in `test.js`.
2. Press `Ctrl+I` / `Cmd+I` and type: `add comments to each line`
3. Click **Accept** or **Keep**.

Test 4: Chat modes and models

At the bottom of the Chat panel, find these two dropdowns. You do not need to change them now. The trainer shows each mode on Day 1.

Dropdown	Option	What it means
Mode	**Ask**	Answers questions. Does not change files.
Mode	**Edit**	Changes the files you add to the chat
Mode	**Agent**	Plans, changes many files and runs terminal commands
Model	e.g. Haiku 4.5, GPT-5 mini	The AI model that answers

Optional: Copilot CLI (Copilot in the terminal). Follow the login steps it shows. Type `/exit` to leave.

```
TERMINAL
npm install -g @github/copilot
copilot
```

Handy shortcuts

Action	Windows	Mac
Accept suggestion	`Tab`	`Tab`
Reject suggestion	`Esc`	`Esc`
Accept next word only	`Ctrl+→`	`Cmd+→`
Next / previous suggestion	`Alt+]` / `Alt+[`	`Option+]` / `Option+[`
Inline chat	`Ctrl+I`	`Cmd+I`
Open Chat panel	`Ctrl+Alt+I`	`Cmd+Ctrl+I`

09 Step 8: Accounts for the lab

Create these 3 free accounts now so you do not lose lab time. Use **Sign in with GitHub** for Supabase and Vercel.

Account	Link	What to do now
Supabase	supabase.com	Sign in with GitHub. Do not create a project yet.

Account	Link	What to do now
Google AI Studio	aistudio.google.com	Sign in with your Google account and accept the terms. Do not create a key yet.
Vercel	vercel.com/signup	Choose **Hobby** (free), then **Continue with GitHub**

You create the Supabase project and the Gemini API key in the lab, with the trainer.

10 Step 9: Run the starter project

This final test proves your laptop is ready. You do not need any API keys for it.

1. Open VS Code, then open the terminal.
2. Make a work folder **outside OneDrive** and go into it:

```
TERMINAL

# Windows (PowerShell)
mkdir C:\Projects
cd C:\Projects

# Mac
mkdir ~/Projects
cd ~/Projects
```

3. Download the starter project and open it in VS Code:

```
TERMINAL

git clone https://github.com/learn2simple/campusbite-live.git
cd campusbite-live
code .
```

4. In the new VS Code window, open the terminal and install the packages. This takes 1 to 3 minutes.

```
TERMINAL

npm install
```

5. Build the project. You should see **Compiled successfully**.

```
TERMINAL

npm run build
```

6. Start the app:

```
TERMINAL
npm run dev
```

7. Open `http://localhost:3000` in your browser. You should see the **Enter team passcode** page. That means everything works.
8. Go back to the terminal and press `Ctrl+C` to stop the app.

This is only a test copy. On Day 1 you create your own copy with **Use this template**, as shown in Guide 2, the CampusBite Handbook. You can delete this test folder after the check.

11 Final checklist

Tick each item. If every box is ticked, you are ready for Day 1.

- [ ] GitHub account created, with two-factor turned on
- [ ] GitHub Education applied for (optional)
- [ ] `git --version` shows a version
- [ ] `git config --global user.email` shows your email
- [ ] `node -v` shows v22 or higher
- [ ] `npm -v` shows a version
- [ ] `code --version` shows a version
- [ ] Copilot icon in VS Code shows you are signed in
- [ ] A Copilot suggestion appeared in `test.js` and Chat answered a question
- [ ] Tailwind CSS IntelliSense, Prettier, REST Client and Error Lens installed
- [ ] Supabase, Google AI Studio and Vercel accounts created
- [ ] Starter project ran and the passcode page opened at localhost:3000

If you are stuck on any step, note the exact error message and show it to the trainer at the start of Day 1.

12 Fixing common problems

Problem	Fix
`git`, `node` or `code` is "not recognized"	Close VS Code and every terminal, then open them again. If it still fails, restart the laptop.

Problem	Fix
Windows PowerShell: "running scripts is disabled" when running `npm`	Switch the VS Code terminal to Git Bash (Step 4), or run `Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned` in PowerShell and type `Y`
`npm install` is very slow or fails	College Wi-Fi may block it. Try a mobile hotspot, then run `npm install` again. Also make sure the folder is not inside OneDrive.
No Copilot suggestions appear	Check the Copilot icon in the status bar. Sign in again if it shows a warning. Make sure the file has a code extension like `.js` or `.ts`.
Copilot Chat or Agent mode is missing	Update VS Code, open **View** → **Chat**, and check that **Chat: Disable AI Features** is unticked in Settings
Copilot says the free limit is reached	Inline suggestions and chat have separate limits, so keep coding with inline suggestions. Save chat for bigger tasks. Never share your GitHub account with others.
Browser login for Copilot does not return to VS Code	Copy the code VS Code shows, paste it in the browser page, and allow the browser to open VS Code
Port 3000 is already in use	Run `npm run dev -- -p 3001` and open localhost:3001
`git clone` asks for a password	Use the HTTPS link from GitHub and sign in through the browser window that opens
Mac: "command line developer tools" pop-up keeps coming back	Run `xcode-select --install` in Terminal and wait for it to finish